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United States Patent	12396843
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
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Heat tunable intraocular lens

Abstract

A method and system provide an ophthalmic lens including a lens body having a chamber therein, a reservoir module coupled with the lens body and an optical fluid. At least part of the lens body is flexible. The reservoir module includes a reservoir and a heat sensitive portion bordering the reservoir. The reservoir has a reservoir volume and is fluidically connected with the chamber. The heat sensitive portion has a shape responsive to a temperature of at least forty five degrees Celsius such that the reservoir volume changes in response to at least part of the heat sensitive portion reaching the temperature. The optical fluid resides in the chamber and the reservoir. A change in the reservoir volume flows a portion of the optical fluid between the reservoir and the chamber such that the flexible portion of the lens body undergoes a shape change corresponding to a base power change.

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Appl. No.: 18/306347

Filed: April 25, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230255751 A1	Aug. 17, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 16861379 20200429 US 11666432 child-doc US 18306347
continuation parent-doc US 16189115 20181113 US 10786348 20200929 child-doc US 16861379
division parent-doc US 15275625 20160926 US 10159566 20181225 child-doc US 16189115

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A61F2/16 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC A61F2/1659 (20130101); A61F2/1613 (20130101); A61F2/1618 (20130101);
A61F2/1635 (20130101); A61F2/1627 (20130101); A61F2002/169 (20150401);
A61F2210/0014 (20130101); A61F2210/0047 (20130101); A61F2210/0061 (20130101);
A61F2230/0065 (20130101); A61F2250/0003 (20130101); A61F2250/0009 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A61F (2/1613); A61F (2/1627); A61F (2/1635); A61F (2250/0003); A61F (2/1659); A61F
(2210/0014); A61F (2210/0047)

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Background/Summary

PRIORITY CLAIM (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. Continuation application Ser. No. 16/861,379 filed on Apr. 29, 2020, which is a continuation of U.S. Divisional application Ser. No. 16/189,115, which claims the benefit of priority of U.S. Non-Provisional patent application Ser. No. 15/275,625 titled “Heat Tunable Intraocular Lens,” filed on Sep. 26 2016, whose inventors are Ramiro Ribeiro, Douglas Schlueter, Lukas Scheibler, Ahmad R. Hadba, Stefan Troller and Marcel Ackermann, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety as though fully and completely set forth herein.

FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally ophthalmic lenses and, more particularly, to a heat tunable intraocular lens.

BACKGROUND

(2) Intraocular lenses (IOLs) are implanted in patients' eyes either to replace a patient's lens or, in the case of a phakic IOL, to complement the patient's lens. Some conventional IOLs are single focal length IOLs, while others are multifocal IOLs. Single focal length IOLs have a single focal length or single power. Objects at the focal length from the eye/IOL are in focus, while objects nearer or further away may be out of focus. Multifocal IOLs, on the other hand, have at least two focal lengths. Multifocal lenses may assist patients having conditions such as near-sightedness. In general, a physician selects an IOL having the appropriate base power and other characteristics for the patient. During ophthalmic surgery, often performed for other conditions such as cataracts, the selected IOL is implanted.

(3) Although the IOLs function acceptably well in most patients, the selected IOL may have incorrect power for the patient. The IOL can be removed and a new IOL selected and implanted. However, performing additional ophthalmic surgeries for this purpose is undesirable. Other IOLs may have their power adjusted noninvasively. For example, the IOL may be sensitive to ultraviolet (UV) light. Such an IOL may be exposed to UV light in order to change the power of the lens. The exposure to UV light may change the shape of the IOL and, therefore, the base power of the lens. Although this method allows the base power of the IOL to be adjusted, such an IOL requires the patient to wear UV light blocking glasses at all times until an adjustment phase is completed. The adjustment phase is typically on the order of two weeks. Requiring a patient to wear UV light blocking glasses twenty-four hours per day for two weeks is inconvenient for the patient and undesirable. Once the adjustment phase is completed, the changes to the IOL must be locked in to prevent further changes to the IOL power due to every day exposure to UV light. Once these changes are locked in, no further adjustments may be made to the base power of the IOL. Other mechanisms, such as a change in tension, exist to change the base power of the lens. However, these mechanisms have attendant issues shortcomings.

(4) Accordingly, what is needed is an improved mechanism for noninvasively changing the base power of an IOL.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) A method and system provide an ophthalmic lens including a lens body having a chamber therein, a reservoir module coupled with the lens body and an optical fluid. At least a portion of the

lens body is flexible. The reservoir module includes a heat sensitive portion and has a reservoir therein. The reservoir has a reservoir volume and is fluidically connected with the chamber. The heat sensitive portion of the reservoir module borders at least a portion of the reservoir. The heat sensitive portion has a shape responsive to a temperature of at least forty five degrees Celsius such that the reservoir volume changes in response to at least part of the heat sensitive portion reaching the temperature. The optical fluid resides in the chamber and the reservoir. The optical fluid has an optical fluid index of refraction that matches the lens body index of refraction to within 0.1. A change in the reservoir volume flows a portion of the optical fluid between the reservoir and the chamber such that the at least the portion of the lens body undergoes a shape change corresponding to a base power change.

(6) According to the method and system disclosed herein, a physician may be better and more easily able to noninvasively change the power of an implanted ophthalmic device such as an IOL.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) For a more complete understanding of the present disclosure and the advantages thereof, reference is now made to the following description taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings in which like reference numerals indicate like features and wherein:

(2) FIGS. 1A-1E depict various views of an exemplary embodiment of a heat tunable ophthalmic device;

(3) FIGS. 2A-2D depict various views of another exemplary embodiment of a heat tunable ophthalmic device;

(4) FIGS. 3A-3B depict various views of another exemplary embodiment of a heat tunable ophthalmic lens;

(5) FIG. 4 depicts a perspective cutaway view of another exemplary embodiment of a heat tunable ophthalmic lens;

(6) FIG. 5 is a flow chart depicting an exemplary embodiment of a method for providing a heat tunable ophthalmic device; and

(7) FIG. 6 is a flow chart depicting an exemplary embodiment of a method for using a heat tunable ophthalmic device.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

(8) The exemplary embodiments relate to ophthalmic devices such as intraocular lenses (IOLs). The following description is presented to enable one of ordinary skill in the art to make and use the invention and is provided in the context of a patent application and its requirements. Various modifications to the exemplary embodiments and the generic principles and features described herein will be readily apparent. The exemplary embodiments are mainly described in terms of particular methods and systems provided in particular implementations. However, the methods and systems will operate effectively in other implementations. Phrases such as “exemplary embodiment”, “one embodiment” and “another embodiment” may refer to the same or different embodiments as well as to multiple embodiments. The embodiments will be described with respect to systems and/or devices having certain components. However, the systems and/or devices may include more or less components than those shown, and variations in the arrangement and type of the components may be made without departing from the scope of the invention. The exemplary embodiments will also be described in the context of particular methods having certain steps. However, the method and system operate effectively for other methods having different and/or additional steps and steps in different orders that are not inconsistent with the exemplary embodiments. Thus, the present invention is not intended to be limited to the embodiments shown, but is to be accorded the widest scope consistent with the principles and features described herein.

The method and system are also described in terms of singular items rather than plural items. One of ordinary skill in the art will recognize that these singular terms encompass plural. For example, a chamber may include one or more chambers.

(9) A method and system provide an ophthalmic lens including a lens body having a chamber therein, a reservoir module coupled with the lens body and an optical fluid. At least a portion of the lens body is flexible. The reservoir module includes a heat sensitive portion and has a reservoir therein. The reservoir has a reservoir volume and is fluidically connected with the chamber. The heat sensitive portion of the reservoir module borders at least a portion of the reservoir. The heat sensitive portion has a shape responsive to a temperature of at least forty five degrees Celsius such that the reservoir volume changes in response to at least part of the heat sensitive portion reaching the temperature. The optical fluid resides in the chamber and the reservoir. The optical fluid has an optical fluid index of refraction that matches the lens body index of refraction to within 0.1. A change in the reservoir volume flows a portion of the optical fluid between the reservoir and the chamber such that the at least the portion of the lens body undergoes a shape change corresponding to a base power change.

(10) FIGS. 1A-1E depict an exemplary embodiment of a heat tunable ophthalmic device **100** that may be used as an IOL. For simplicity, the ophthalmic device **100** is referred to hereinafter as an IOL **100**. FIG. 1A depicts a plan view of the IOL **100**, while FIGS. 1B-1E depicts side views of the ophthalmic lens **110**. For clarity, FIGS. 1A-1E are not to scale. The IOL **100** includes an ophthalmic lens **110** as well as haptics **102** and **104**. Portions of the ophthalmic lens **110** may include a variety of optical materials including but not limited to one or more of silicone, a hydrogel and an acrylic. Haptics **102** and **104** are used to hold the ophthalmic device **100** in place in a patient's eye (not explicitly shown). However, in other embodiments, other mechanism(s) might be used to retain the ophthalmic device in position in the eye. For clarity, the haptics are not depicted in FIGS. 1B-3C, discussed below. Although the ophthalmic lens **110** is depicted as having a circular cross section in the plan view of FIG. 1A, in other embodiments, other shapes may be used.

(11) The ophthalmic lens **110** (hereinafter “lens”) has an optic axis **106** as well a lens body **120**, a reservoir module **130** and optical fluid **140**. Although termed part of the lens **110**, the optic axis **106** may be considered an imaginary line that passes through the centers of the anterior surface and posterior surface. Thus, the optic axis **106** is shown as a dashed line. The optic axis **106** may also be perpendicular to the surfaces and at the point at which it passes through the surfaces. Although not shown, the anterior and/or posterior surface may have other features included but not limited to diffraction grating(s). Although indicated as separate components, the reservoir module **130** and the lens body **120** may be integrated together into a single piece. For example, some or all of the lens body **120** and reservoir module may be a monolithic structure formed together.

(12) The lens body **120** forms the primary optical component of the IOL **100**. Thus, light passes through the lens body **120** and other components of the eye, allowing the patient to see. In some embodiments, the reservoir module **130** is not designed to transmit light used in vision. The lens body **120** includes a base **122**, a flexible portion **124** and a chamber **126**. In the embodiment shown, the flexible portion **124** is considered to be a flexible membrane **124**. Consequently, the flexible portion **124** is referred to hereinafter as a flexible membrane **124**. However, nothing prevents the flexible portion from having another configuration. The chamber **126** may be considered to be the space between the base **122** and the flexible membrane **124**. An optical fluid **140**, discussed below, resides in at least the chamber **126**.

(13) In the embodiment shown, the base **122** has stable optical properties. Thus, the base **122** may be relatively fixed in shape. In other embodiments, the base **122** may change shape somewhat in response to changes in the volume of the chamber **126**. In contrast, the flexible membrane **124** is flexible and changes shape in response to a change in volume of the reservoir **126**.

(14) In some embodiments, the base **122** and flexible membrane **124** may be made of the same

material, such as AcrySof®, AcrySof® 2 and/or other soft optical material(s) might be used. In other embodiments, the base **122** and the flexible membrane **124** may be made of different materials. The base **122** may be sufficiently thick that the shape of the base **122** remains substantially unchanged. However, the flexible membrane **124** is sufficiently thin to respond to changes to the volume of the chamber **126**. For example, the flexible membrane **124** may be at least eighty micrometers thick and not more than three hundred micrometers thick. In other embodiments, other thicknesses are possible. In some embodiments, the flexible membrane **124** has a uniform thickness prior to the optical fluid **140** being provided. In other embodiments, the thickness of the flexible membrane **124** may be nonuniform.

(15) The reservoir module **130** is at the periphery of the lens body **120** and includes reservoir **132A/132B** and a heat sensitive portion **134**. In FIGS. **1B-1D**, cross sections are shown. Thus, the reservoir **132A** and reservoir **132B** (collectively referred to as reservoir **132A/132B**) and the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** are shown. In some embodiments, the reservoirs **132A** and **132B** are connected within the reservoir module **130** such that fluid may flow around the periphery of the lens body **120**. For example, the reservoirs **132A** and **132B** may simply be part of a hollow torus (i.e. a tube). In other embodiments, the reservoirs **132A** and **132B** may be disconnected such that any fluid flow between the reservoirs **132A** and **132B** occurs through the chamber **126** of the lens body **120**. The reservoirs **132A** and **132B** may have different shape(s) in other embodiments.

(16) The reservoir **132A** and **132B** are fluidically connected with the chamber **126** of the lens body **120**. In the embodiment shown, there are simply inlets/exits (i.e. apertures or channels) between the chamber **126** and the reservoirs **132A** and **132B**. In other embodiments, the fluid path between the chamber **126** and the reservoir(s) **132A** and/or **132B** may be more complex.

(17) The optical fluid **140** resides in the chamber **126** and reservoir **132A/132B**. For simplicity, the optical fluid **140** is only separately labeled in FIG. **1B**. In FIGS. **1C-1E**, the optical fluid is labeled along with the reservoir **132A/132B** and the chamber **126**. The optical fluid **140** may flow between the chamber **126** and the reservoir **132A/132B**. Because the optical fluid **140** can be in the chamber **126**, the optical fluid **140** is in the path of light used for vision. Thus, the optical fluid **140** transmits light. Because light is refracted by the lens body **120**, the optical fluid **140** may also have an index of refraction that matches that of the lens body **120** (e.g. at least the base **122** and in some embodiments the base **122** and flexible membrane **124**) to within particular limits. For example, in some embodiments, the index of refraction of the optical fluid **140** is within 0.1 of that of the lens body **120**. In some embodiments, the index of refraction of the optical fluid **140** is not more than 0.05 different from that of the lens body **120**. If the lens body **120** is made of a material such as AcrySof® or AcrySof® 2, the optical fluid **140** may be a high molecular weight aromatic silicone copolymer liquid.

(18) The heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** of the reservoir module **130** may be part of a single heat sensitive portion. For example, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** may be part of a torus that occupies one wall of the reservoir **132A/132B**. The heat sensitive portions **134A/134B** may have different shapes in other embodiments. For example, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and/or **134B** may be spherical, hemispherical, cubic, elliptical or have other discrete shapes. These shapes may be connected or separate. In addition, the heat sensitive portion **134A** may have a different shape than the heat sensitive portion **134B**. In the embodiment shown, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** have different sizes. However, in other embodiments, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** may have the same size.

(19) The heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** change shape in response to a particular temperature (hereinafter, the “glass transition temperature”) being reached. In the embodiment shown, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** are formed of the same material and have the same glass transition temperature. In other embodiments, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** may be formed of different materials and/or have different glass transition temperatures. This glass transition temperature of the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** is desired to be above the

normal temperature of the eye. The glass transition temperature is also desired to be sufficiently low that the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** may reach the glass transition temperature without damaging the eye. In some embodiments, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** are sufficiently small that localized heating of these portions **134A** and **134B** does not adversely affect the eye even though temperatures well above the normal temperature of the eye are reached by the portions **134A** and **134B**. For example, the normal temperature of the eye in which the IOL **100** is desired to reside may be approximately thirty-five degrees Celsius through forty degrees Celsius. The glass transition temperature of the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** may be at least forty five degrees Celsius. In some embodiments, the glass transition temperature may be at least sixty degrees Celsius. In other embodiments, the glass transition temperature may be at least ninety degrees Celsius in some embodiments. In addition, the glass transition temperature may be desired to be less than one hundred degrees Celsius.

(20) At the normal temperature of the eye the shapes of the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** are constant. If one or both of the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** are heated to the glass transition temperature, the shape(s) change. Upon cooling, the heat sensitive portion(s) **134A** and **134B** retain the new shape. This shape then remains constant. Thus, normal wear of the IOL **100** does not affect the base power of the lens **110** or the shape of the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B**. For example, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** may be formed of a shape memory material, such as a shape memory polymer (SMP). In addition, the SMP may have an additive (e.g., a dye or other material) added to absorb the light in the wavelength range provided by a laser for heating.

(21) Operation of the IOL **100** may be seen in FIGS. **1B-1E**. Initially, as shown in FIG. **1B**, the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** have a particular shape. The heat sensitive portion **134A** may be heated to at or above the glass transition temperature. In some embodiments, this heating is accomplished via a laser. For example, a laser may be aimed and fired at the heat sensitive portion **134A**. The wavelength of the laser is selected to be transmitted through the cornea and vitreous humor of the eye. In some embodiments, the laser may have a characteristic wavelength of approximately 1064 nm. In other embodiments, the laser may be in the wavelength bandwidth of 750-850 nanometers. The heat sensitive portion **134A** heats to at least the glass transition temperature and changes shape.

(22) FIG. **1C** depicts the lens **110** after heating of the heat sensitive portion **134A** to at least the glass transition temperature. The lens **110** may also have been cooled. The heat sensitive portion **134A'** has changed shape. As a result, the volume of the reservoir **132A'** has decreased. This forces some of the optical fluid **140** into the chamber **126'**. Because the flexible membrane **124'** is not rigid, movement of the optical fluid **140** into the chamber **126'** increases the volume of the chamber **126'** and changes the shape of the flexible membrane **124'**. Thus, the power of the lens **110** has been changed. Based on the changes in volume of the reservoir **132A'** and chamber **126'** and the properties of the flexible membrane **124'** and the optical fluid **140**, the change in the base power of the lens **110** may be determined.

(23) Alternatively, the heat sensitive portion **134B** may be heated to at or above the glass transition temperature. Heating may be accomplished using a laser or similar mechanism in the same manner as describe above. FIG. **1D** depicts the lens **110** after heating of the heat sensitive portion **134B**. The lens **110** may also have been cooled. The heat sensitive portion **134B'** has changed shape. As a result, the volume of the reservoir **132B'** has decreased. This forces some of the optical fluid **140** into the chamber **126''**. Because the flexible membrane **124''** is not rigid, movement of the optical fluid **140** into the chamber **126''** increases the volume of the chamber **126''** and changes the shape of the flexible membrane **124''**. Thus, the power of the lens **110** has been changed. Based on the changes in volume of the reservoir **132B'** and chamber **126''** and the properties of the flexible membrane **124''** and the optical fluid **140**, the change in the base power of the lens **110** may be determined. However, because the volume change of the reservoir **132B'** is smaller, the change in

the base power of the lens **110** is less in FIG. **1D** than FIG. **10**.

(24) Both heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** may be heated to at or above the glass transition temperature. Heating may be accomplished using a laser or similar mechanism in the same manner as describe above. FIG. **1E** depicts the lens **110** after heating of the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B**. The lens **110** may also have been cooled. The heat sensitive portions **134A'** and **134B'** have changed shape. As a result, the volumes of the reservoirs **132A'** and **132B'** have decreased. This forces some of the optical fluid **140** into the chamber **126''**. Because the flexible membrane **124'''** is not rigid, movement of the optical fluid **140** into the chamber **126'''** increases the volume of the chamber **126'''** and changes the shape of the flexible membrane **124''**. Thus, the power of the lens **110** has been changed. Based on the changes in volumes of the reservoirs **132A'** and **132B'** and chamber **126'''** and the properties of the flexible membrane **124'''** and the optical fluid **140**, the change in the base power of the lens **110** may be determined. Because the volume changes of the reservoirs **132A'** and **132B'** are larger, the change in the base power of the lens **110** is greater in FIG. **1E** than FIGS. **10** and **1D**. For example, if the base power of the lens **110** changes by 0.25 diopter for the situation shown in FIG. **1D**, then the base power may change by 0.5 diopter for the situation shown in FIG. **10** and by 0.75 diopter for the situation shown in FIG. **1E**. Further, the changes shown in FIGS. **10**, **1D** and **1E** need not occur at the same time. Instead, these changes may be made later based on updated information and/or changes to the patient's eye.

(25) The base power of the lens **110** and thus the IOL **100** may be changed if the lens **110** has the incorrect base power for the patient or the patient's vision changes over time. In some configurations, the power of the lens **110** may be able to be adjusted up or down depending upon whether there is a volume decrease or increase in the reservoir **132A/132B**. Because the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B** may be changed via laser, the power of the lens **110** may be changed noninvasively. Thus, the risks of invasive procedures such as changing of the IOL may be avoided. Instead, a simple office visit may be all that is required. Changing the base power of the lens **110** via laser heating may also be more cost effective than changing the entire IOL. In addition, drawbacks of other noninvasive mechanisms for changing the base power of the lens may be avoided. For example, changes need not be locked into the lens **110**. Instead, additional heat might be applied at any time throughout the life of the lens **110**. Further, the lens **110** does not require special eyewear, such as UV light protective eyewear worn around the clock, around the time the base power is adjusted. In addition, a single office visit may be sufficient to adjust the power of the lens **110**. The adjustment may also be quicker. In some cases, the heating, rapid change in shape of the heat sensitive portions **134A/134B**, flow of fluid between the reservoir **132A/132B** and the chamber **126**, the change in volume of the chamber **126** and the attendant change in base power of the lens may take a matter of minutes or less. Thus, the lens **110** may be more easily tuned to the needs of the patients.

(26) FIGS. **2A-2D** depict another exemplary embodiment of a heat tunable ophthalmic lens **150** that may be used as or in an IOL. For simplicity, the ophthalmic lens **150** is referred to hereinafter as lens **150**. FIGS. **2A-2D** depict side views of the ophthalmic lens **110**. For clarity, FIGS. **2A-2D** are not to scale. The lens **150** may be part of an IOL, such as the IOL **100**, that includes the lens **150** and may include haptics (not shown in FIGS. **2A-2E**).

(27) The lens **150** has an optic axis **156** as well a lens body **160**, a reservoir module **170** and optical fluid **190**. The lens body **160**, reservoir module **170**, optical fluid **190** and optic axis **156** are analogous to the lens body **120**, reservoir module **130**, optical fluid **140** and optic axis **106**, respectively. Thus, the lens body **160**, base **162**, flexible membrane **164** and chamber **166** are analogous to the lens body **120**, base **122**, flexible membrane **124** and chamber **126**, respectively. Similarly, the reservoir module **170**, reservoir **172A/172B** and heat sensitive portions **174A** and **174B** are analogous to the reservoir module **130**, reservoir **132A/132B** and heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134B**, respectively. Finally, the optical fluid **190** is analogous to the optical fluid **140**. Thus, the structure, function and materials of these components may be analogous to those

discussed above. For example, the index of refraction of the optical fluid **190** may match the index of refraction of the lens body **160** to within the tolerances discussed above. Although not shown, the anterior and/or posterior surface may have other features included but not limited to diffraction grating(s). Although indicated as separate components, the reservoir module **170** and the lens body **160** may be integrated together into a single piece.

(28) Also shown is a microfluidic path **180** that connects the reservoir **172A/172B** with the chamber **166**. The ends of the microfluidic path **180** are shown as dashed lines indicating inlets/outlets to the chamber **166** and reservoir **172A/172B**. In some embodiments, the microfluidic path **180** is simply a straight channel. However, in other embodiments, the microfluidic path **180** may have another, more complex structure.

(29) The lens body **170** forms the primary optical component of the lens **150**. In contrast, the reservoir module **170** may not be designed to transmit light used in vision. In the embodiment shown, the flexible membrane **164** is pliable and has optical properties that may change in response to an alteration in the volume of the chamber **166**. In contrast, the base **162** has stable optical properties and may be relatively fixed in shape. In other embodiments, the base **162** may change shape somewhat in response to changes in the volume of the chamber **166**.

(30) The reservoir module **170** is at the periphery of the lens body **160**. In some embodiments, the reservoirs **172A** and **172B** are connected within the reservoir module **170** such that fluid may flow around the periphery of the lens body **160**. In other embodiments, the reservoirs **172A** and **172B** may be disconnected such that any fluid flow between the reservoirs **172A** and **172B** occurs through the chamber **166** of the lens body **160**. The reservoirs **172A** and **172B** may have different shape(s) in other embodiments.

(31) The heat sensitive portions **174A** and **174B** of the reservoir module **130** may be part of a single heat sensitive portion. For example, the heat sensitive portions **174A** and **174B** may be part of a torus that occupies one wall of the reservoir **172A/172B**. Alternatively, the heat sensitive portions **174A** and **174B** may be composed of discrete units. For example, in FIGS. 2A-2D, each heat sensitive portion **174A** and **174B** includes multiple capsules **175A** and **175B**, respectively. For simplicity, only one capsule **175A** and **175B** in each heat sensitive portion **174A** and **174B**, respectively, is labeled. In some embodiments, each capsule **175A** and/or **175B** is a single heat sensitive structure that may be thermally isolated from other capsules. In other embodiments, the capsules **175A** and **175B** are part of a single heat sensitive structure. Selected regions of the heat sensitive portion **174A** and **174B** may be individually heated to or above their glass transition temperature(s). In the embodiment shown, the capsules **175A** and **175B** are roughly hemispherical. However, nothing prevents the use of another shape. In the embodiment shown, each of the capsules **175A** and **175B** has the same size. Thus, each capsules **175A** and **175B** may contain/displace the same volume of optical fluid **190**. In other embodiments the capsules **175A** and/or **175B** may have different sizes. The volume of optical fluid contained/displaced in each capsule **175A** and **175B** is still desired to be known and to correspond to a known change in base power. For example, each capsule **175A** and **175B** may correspond to a base power change of 0.25 diopter, to within desired tolerances. In some cases, this corresponds to a volume for each capsule **175A** and **175B** of 0.2 mm³. However, other volumes and other base power changes may be used. For example, one capsule **175A** might correspond to a 0.25 diopter change, another capsule **175A** might correspond to a 0.5 diopter change, and so on. In some embodiments, a change in power of four diopters (e.g. ± 2 diopters) may be provided.

(32) Each of the capsules **175A** and **175B** changes shape in response to the glass transition temperature being reached by the capsule **175A** and **175B**. After cooling this new shape is stable. Below the glass transition temperature, the shape is substantially fixed as either a capsule or a flat surface. This glass transition temperature of the heat sensitive portions **174A** and **174B** is desired to be significantly above the normal temperature of the eye and sufficiently low that the heat sensitive portions **174A** and **174B** may reach the glass transition temperature without damaging the eye. In

some embodiments, the capsules **175A** and **175B** are sufficiently small that localized heating of these capsules **175A** and **175B** does not adversely affect the eye even though temperatures well above the normal temperature of the eye are reached by the portions **174A** and **174B**. The capsules **175A** and **175B** may be formed of the SMP described above and may have the glass transition temperature(s) described above.

(33) As can be seen in FIG. 2A, the orientations of the capsules **175A** and **175B** with respect to the reservoirs **172A** and **172B** differ. In particular, each of the capsules **175A** displaces a roughly hemispherical volume of optical fluid **190** from the reservoir **172A**. Each of the capsules **175B** includes a roughly hemispherical volume of optical fluid **190** in the reservoir **172B**. As a result, the base power of the lens **150** may be increased or decreased by varying amounts depending upon whether a capsule **175A** or a capsule **175B** is heated to or above its glass transition temperature and the number of capsules **175A** or **175B** so heated.

(34) Operation of the lens **150** is discussed with respect to FIGS. 2A-2D. In the ensuing discussion, it is assumed that the lens **150** initially has the configuration shown in FIG. 2A. If the base power of the lens **150** is too high, then the lens **150** is desired to refract light less. This may be accomplished by reducing the curvature of the flexible membrane **164**. Because of their orientation with respect to the reservoir **172A**, a change in shape of the capsules **175A**/heat sensitive portion **174A** may be used. More specifically, heat is applied to one or more of the capsules **175A**, for example via a laser. The temperature of this capsule **175A** is raised to above its glass transition temperature. Consequently, the capsule **175A** changes shape.

(35) FIG. 2B depicts an exemplary embodiment of the lens **150** after enough heat is applied to the capsule **175A** is the closest to the microfluidic path **180** to raise the temperature of the capsule **175A** to at or above the glass transition temperature. The lens **150** may subsequently have been cooled to the ambient temperature of the eye. The capsule **175A** closest to the chamber **166'** has now flattened. This capsule has changed from a first shape (hemispherical) to a second shape (substantially flat). This shape change is stable after cooling. As a result, the reservoir **172A'** has increased volume by the approximately the volume of the capsule **175A**. The reservoir **172B** remains unchanged. Consequently, optical fluid **190** has flowed from the chamber **166'** through the microfluidic path **180** to the reservoir **172A'**. The pressure from the optical fluid **190** on the flexible membrane **164'** is reduced. The flexible membrane **164'** flattens and the chamber **166'** has a corresponding reduction in volume. The optical power of the lens body **160** is, therefore, reduced. Consequently, the base power of the lens **150** has been noninvasively reduced.

(36) In contrast, suppose the base optical power of the lens **150** is desired to be increased from the situation shown in FIG. 2A. To do so, the curvature of the flexible membrane **164** is desired to be increased. If one or more of the capsules **175B** is heat treated to reach a temperature at or exceeding the glass transition temperature, the capsule(s) **175B** flattens. Suppose heat is applied to a single capsule **175B**, for example via a laser. The temperature of this capsule **175B** is raised to above to glass transition temperature of the capsule **175B**. Consequently, the capsule **175B** changes shape.

(37) FIG. 2C depicts an exemplary embodiment of the lens **150** after enough heat is applied to the capsule **175B'** is the closest to the microfluidic path **180** to raise the temperature of the capsule **175B'** to at or above the glass transition temperature. The lens **150** may also have been subsequently cooled to the ambient temperature of the eye. In the heat sensitive portion **174B'** of the reservoir module **170**, the capsule closest to the chamber **166''** has now flattened. This capsule has changed from a hemispherical to substantially flat. As a result, the reservoir **172B'** has decreased volume by the approximately the volume of a capsule **175B**. The reservoir **172A** remains unchanged. Consequently, optical fluid **190** has flowed from the reservoir **172B'** through the microfluidic path **180** to the chamber **166''**. The pressure from the optical fluid **190** on the flexible membrane **164''** is increased. The chamber **166''** increases in volume and the flexible membrane **164''** has a corresponding increase in curvature. The change in volume of the chamber **166''** can but

need not be equal to the volume of a capsule **175B**. The optical power of the lens **110** is, therefore, increased. Consequently, the base power of the lens **150** may be noninvasively enhanced.

(38) It may be determined that the power of the lens **150** is desired to be further increased. In such a case, more capsule(s) **175B** may be heat treated. Such a situation is shown in FIG. **2D**. As can be seen from the heat sensitive portion **174B''**, another capsule **175B** has been heat treated and, therefore, is flat. The volume of the reservoir **172B''** is further decreased. The optical fluid **190** flows from the reservoir **172B''** to the chamber **166''**. The increase pressure of the optical fluid in the chamber **164''** causes further deformation of the flexible membrane **164''** and an increase in the volume of the chamber **166''**. Consequently, the optical power of the lens **150** is further increased. Note that the optical power of the lens **150** may be decreased again by heat treating one or more of the capsules **175A**.

(39) The properties of the lens **150** may be noninvasively adjusted. More specifically, the base power of the lens **150** may be noninvasively increased and/or decreased. Thus, benefits analogous to those discussed above for the lens **110** may be achieved.

(40) FIGS. **3A-3B** depict various views of another exemplary embodiment of a heat tunable ophthalmic lens **200**. For simplicity, the ophthalmic lens **200** is referred to hereinafter as lens **200**. FIGS. **3A-3B** depict side and perspective views of portions of the lens **200**. For clarity, FIGS. **3A-3B** are not to scale. The lens **200** may be part of an IOL, such as the IOL **100**, that includes a lens as well as haptics (not shown in FIGS. **3A-3B**). For simplicity, the optic axes are not shown.

(41) The lens **200** has a lens body **210**, a reservoir module **220**, microfluidic path **230** and optical fluid (not specifically shown in FIGS. **3A-3B**). The lens body **210**, reservoir module **220**, microfluidic path **230** and optical fluid are analogous to the lens body **120/160**, reservoir module **130/170**, microfluidic path **180** and optical fluid **140/190**, respectively. Thus, the lens body **210**, base **212**, flexible membrane **214** and chamber **216** are analogous to the lens body **120/160**, base **122/162**, flexible membrane **124/164** and chamber **126/166**, respectively. Similarly, the reservoir module **220**, reservoir **222** and heat sensitive portions **224** are analogous to the reservoir module **130/170**, reservoir **132A/132B/172A/172B** and heat sensitive portions **134A/134B/174A/174B**, respectively. The structure, function and materials of these components may be analogous to those discussed above. Although not shown, the anterior and/or posterior surface may have other features included but not limited to diffraction grating(s). Although indicated as separate components, the reservoir module **210** and the lens body **220** may be integrated together into a single piece.

(42) In the embodiment shown, the reservoir **222** has walls including individually formed capsules. Each capsule has a heat sensitive portion **224** forming the walls of the capsule. Thus, the heat sensitive portion **224** and capsules **224** are effectively synonymous for the lens **200**. The capsules **224** may be a SMP. In the embodiment shown, each capsule **224** is discrete. Each capsule **224** is shown as having the same volume and orientation. In other embodiments, one or more of the capsules **224** might have a different volume and/or a different orientation. For example, eight of the sixteen capsules **224** shown might have an opposite orientation to that shown. Thus, the capsules **224** might have an orientation analogous to the heat sensitive portions **174A** and **174B** depicted in FIG. **2A**. Thus, both increases and decreases in the base power of the lens **200** may be provided.

(43) The lens **200** functions in an analogous manner to the lenses **110** and **150**. The lens **200** may, therefore, share the benefits of the lenses **110** and/or **150**. In particular, the base power of the lens **200** may be noninvasively tailored to the patient. This may be accomplished by heat treating one or more of the capsules **224**, for example via a laser. Consequently, the base power of the lens **200** may be relatively rapidly and easily tuned throughout the life of the lens **200**.

(44) FIG. **4** depicts a perspective cutaway view of another exemplary embodiment of a heat tunable ophthalmic lens **200'**. For simplicity, the ophthalmic lens **200'** is referred to hereinafter as lens **200'**. For clarity, FIG. **4** is not to scale. The lens **200'** may be part of an IOL, such as the IOL **100**, that includes a lens as well as haptics (not shown in FIG. **4**). For simplicity, the optic axes are not shown.

(45) The lens **200'** has a lens body **210'**, a reservoir module **220'** and optical fluid (not specifically shown in FIG. 4). The lens body **210'**, reservoir module **220'**, microfluidic path **230'** and optical fluid are analogous to the lens body **120/160/210**, reservoir module **130/170/220**, microfluidic path **180/230** and optical fluid **140/190**, respectively. Thus, the lens body **210'**, base **212'**, flexible membrane **214'** and chamber **216'** are analogous to the lens body **120/160/210**, base **122/162/212**, flexible membrane **124/164/214** and chamber **126/166/216**, respectively. Similarly, the reservoir module **220'**, reservoir **222'** and heat sensitive portions **224'** are analogous to the reservoir module **130/170/220**, reservoir **132A/132B/172A/172B/222** and heat sensitive portions **134A/134B/174A/174B/220**, respectively. The structure, function and materials of these components may be analogous to those discussed above. Although not shown, the anterior and/or posterior surface may have other features included but not limited to diffraction grating(s). Although indicated as separate components, the reservoir module **210'** and the lens body **220'** may be integrated together into a single piece.

(46) In the embodiment shown, the reservoir **222'** has walls including individually formed spherical capsules. Thus, the capsules for the lens **200'** are spherical instead of hemispherical. Each capsule has a heat sensitive portion **224'** forming the walls of the capsule. Thus, the heat sensitive portion **224'** and spherical capsules **224'** are effectively synonymous for the lens **200**. The spherical capsules **224'** may be a SMP. In the embodiment shown, each spherical capsule **224'** is discrete. Each spherical capsule **224'** is shown as having the same volume. In other embodiments, one or more of the capsules **224'** might have a different volume. In the embodiment shown, the upper and lower hemispherical heat sensitive portions **224'** of the spherical capsules may be individual heat treated.

(47) The lens **200'** functions in an analogous manner to the lenses **110**, **150** and **200**. The lens **200'** may, therefore, share the benefits of the lenses **110**, **150** and/or **200**. In particular, the base power of the lens **200'** may be noninvasively tailored to the patient. This may be accomplished by heat treating one or more of the capsules **224'**, for example via a laser. Consequently, the base power of the lens **200'** may be relatively rapidly and easily tuned throughout the life of the lens **200'**.

(48) FIG. 5 is a flow chart depicting an exemplary embodiment of a method **300** for providing an ophthalmic lens. For simplicity, some steps may be omitted, interleaved, and/or combined. The method **300** is also described in the context of the ophthalmic device **100** and ophthalmic lens **110**. However, the method **300** may be used with one or more of ophthalmic lenses **110**, **150**, **200**, **200'** and/or an analogous ophthalmic device.

(49) The lens body **120** is provided, via step **302**. Step **302** includes providing the base **122**, flexible membrane **124** and cavity **126**. Some or all of the microfluidic path, such as a microfluidic path **180** or **230**, may be provided as part of shaping the lens body **120**. Step **302** may include forming and/or connecting the base **122** and flexible membrane **124** such that the empty space for the chamber **126** resides between them. Step **302** may also include forming any diffraction gratings on the flexible membrane **124** and/or base **122**.

(50) The reservoir module **130** is provided, via step **304**. Step **304** may include providing the heat sensitive portions **134A** and **134** at the border of the reservoir **132A/132B**. For example, the desired SMP, having the appropriate shape, size, glass transition temperature and absorption of laser light is provided. Step **304** may also include forming some or all of the microfluidic path.

(51) If not already completed in steps **302** and **304**, the microfluidic path **180** or **230** is provided, via step **306**. Step **306** may simply include providing an aperture or channel between the chamber **126** and the reservoir **132A/132B**. Alternatively, a more complex path may be formed.

(52) The optical fluid **140** is provided in the lens **110**, via step **308**. Step **308** may include filling the lens **110** with the desired optical fluid **140** and sealing the lens **110**. Thus, the optical fluid **140** may flow between the chamber **126** and the reservoir **132A/132B**. The haptics **102** and **104** may optionally be provided, via step **310**.

(53) Using the method **300**, the IOL **100** and ophthalmic lens(es) **110**, **150**, **200** and/or **200'** may be

provided. Thus, the benefits of one or more of the lenses **110**, **150**, **200** and/or **200'** may be attained. (54) FIG. **6** is a flow chart depicting an exemplary embodiment of a method **350** for treating an ophthalmic condition in a patient and tuning the lens. For simplicity, some steps may be omitted, interleaved, and/or combined. The method **350** is also described in the context of using the IOL **100** and lens **110**. However, the method **350** may be used with one or more of lenses **150**, **200** and/or **200'**.

(55) An IOL **100** that is heat tunable is selected for implantation in an eye of the patient, via step **352**. The IOL **100** includes a lens body **120**, a reservoir module **130**, a fluidic connection between the chamber **126** and the reservoir **132A/132B** and optical fluid **140**. Part of the selection process may involve determining the correction needed for the patient's eyesight and selecting the IOL **100** having the appropriate power.

(56) The IOL **100** is implanted in the patient's eye, via step **354**. Step **354** may include replacing the patient's own lens with the IOL **100** or augmenting the patient's lens with the IOL **100**.

(57) It is determined whether the IOL **100** that was implanted has the correct base power, via step **150**. Step **150** may include re-measuring the patient's vision. This step may take place shortly after implantation or at a remote time. This is because the IOL **100** may be tuned throughout its lifetime in some embodiments. If the base power is correct, then the method terminates.

(58) However, if the base power is not correct, then the base power of the IOL **100** may be noninvasively tuned, via step **358**. If increases or decreases in the base power are desired to be corrected, then a lens analogous to the lens **150** may be selected in step **352**. Step **358** may include locating the desired regions of the heat sensitive portion **134A** and/or **134B** to be heated. A laser may then be aimed at the desired portions of the heat sensitive portions **134A** and/or **134B** and fired until the glass transition temperature has been reached or exceeded. In some embodiments, a low duty cycle may be used for the laser to reduce heating of the eye. Step **358** may be carried out during a single out-patient visit. In addition, steps **356** and **358** may be iteratively repeated until the desired power of the lens **110** is reached. Further, steps **356** and **358** may be repeated at various times throughout the life of the lens **110**.

(59) Using the method **350**, a physician may be able to more quickly and easily tune the base power of the IOL **100** using heat. This may be achieved without requiring additional eyewear for the patient or locking the changes in for the IOL **100**. Consequently, the burden on both the physician and patient may be diminished. The method **350** may also be safer for the patient because the method **350** may be performed non-invasively. Consequently, the benefits of the heat tunable IOL **100** and lenses **110**, **150**, **200** and/or **200'** may be achieved.

(60) A method and system for providing a heat tunable IOL have been described. The method and systems have been described in accordance with the exemplary embodiments shown, and one of ordinary skill in the art will readily recognize that there could be variations to the embodiments, and any variations would be within the spirit and scope of the method and system. Accordingly, many modifications may be made by one of ordinary skill in the art without departing from the spirit and scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. An intraocular lens, comprising: a lens body having a chamber therein, at least a portion of the lens body being flexible, the lens body having a lens body index of refraction; a reservoir region fluidly coupled with the chamber of the lens body and positioned at least partially circumferentially around the chamber of the lens body, the reservoir region comprising a plurality of heat sensitive structures that change shape in response to absorbing light energy from a laser; and an optical fluid residing in the chamber and the reservoir region, the optical fluid having an optical fluid index of refraction, wherein the optical fluid is adapted to move between the reservoir region and the chamber in order to cause a base power change of the intraocular lens; wherein a first portion of the

plurality of heat sensitive structures is configured to absorb light energy to change shape to drive a first volume of optical fluid from the reservoir region to the chamber, wherein the first volume of optical fluid corresponds to a base power change of not more than 0.25 diopter; and wherein a second portion of the plurality of heat sensitive structures is configured to absorb light energy to change shape to drive optical fluid from the chamber to the reservoir region.

2. The intraocular lens of claim 1, wherein the second portion of the plurality of heat sensitive structures is further configured to drive a second volume of optical fluid from the chamber to the reservoir region.
3. The intraocular lens of claim 2, wherein the first volume of optical fluid and the second volume of optical fluid are the same.
4. The intraocular lens of claim 2, wherein the first volume of optical fluid and the second volume of optical fluid are different.
5. The intraocular lens of claim 1, wherein each heat sensitive structure of the first portion of the plurality of heat sensitive structures is further configured to drive a predetermined volume of optical fluid from the reservoir region to the chamber.
6. The intraocular lens of claim 5, wherein each of the predetermined volumes are the same.
7. The intraocular lens of claim 5, wherein each of the predetermined volumes is equal to either a primary volume or a secondary volume.
8. The intraocular lens of claim 1, wherein the plurality of heat sensitive structures are configured to change shape in response to reaching a temperature of at least forty-five degrees Celsius.
9. The intraocular lens of claim 8, wherein the temperature is at least sixty degrees Celsius and not more than one hundred degrees Celsius.
10. The intraocular lens of claim 1, wherein the at least the portion of the lens body includes a flexible membrane.
11. The intraocular lens of claim 1, wherein at least a portion of each of the plurality of heat sensitive structures comprises a shape memory polymer having a glass transition not less than a threshold temperature.
12. The intraocular lens of claim 11, wherein the shape memory polymer comprises an additive that absorbs light energy in a selected wavelength range.
